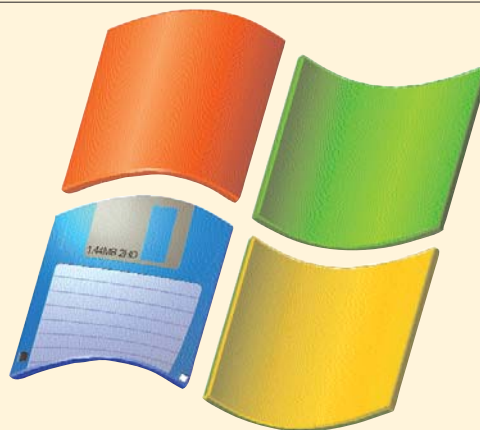


How would you boot into Windows XP via your dust-covered floppy drive?

Send in your solution with the subject "Take a Crack", and your postal address, to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com

THIS MONTH'S CHALLENGE

Boot Into XP Using A Floppy!



LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE



Take a Crack and win

PC Upgrade & Repair Street Smarts

by James Pyles

Published by

WILEY-INDIA

LAST MONTH'S WINNER

**Abhishek Kumar
Tamoli
Hathras, UP**

Rules and Regulations

Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.

Employees of Jasubhai Digital Media and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.

Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Jasubhai Digital Media will not entertain any unsolicited communication.

Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.

Create A Special Folder In Windows Explorer

Last month's solution

How can you create a folder like My Documents—one that will appear as a system folder in XP?

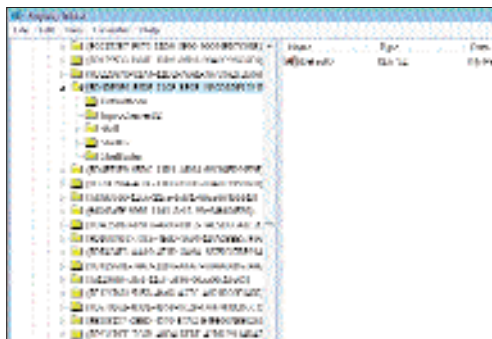
Here's how to create a custom folder in My Computer, one that can't be deleted or renamed.

Step 1

In the Registry Editor, navigate to `HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\CLSID`. Create a new key with a Globally Unique Identifier (GUID). The GUID is a 128-bit identifier that is usually generated by Windows. This can be a random number that is used to uniquely identify COM objects. Create a key using this random GUID: `{FD4DF9E0-E3DE-11CE-BFCF-ABCD1DE12345}`

Step 2

Set the value of the "(Default)" setting for this key to the name of the folder, say "My Personal Data". Create a new sub-key under the main key and call it "DefaultIcon". That is, create a key called: `HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\CLSID\{FD4DF9E0-E3DE-11CE-BFCF-ABCD1DE12345}\DefaultIcon`. Set the value of "(DefaultIcon)" to the



Edit the Registry to make the changes

filename and path of the icon file you want to use for the folder, for example, "C:\Topsec.ico", without the quotes.

If you don't specify a path to an icon

file, Windows will use its default folder icon instead.

Step 3

Create another sub-key under the main key called "InprocServer32", that is, create the key called `HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\CLSID\{FD4DF9E0-E3DE-11CE-BFCF-ABCD1DE12345}\InprocServer32`

Set the "(default)" setting here to "shell32.dll". Create another string value called ThreadingModel and set its value to "Apartment". There's one more: create another sub-key called `HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\CLSID\{FD4DF9E0-E3DE-11CE-BFCF-ABCD1DE12345}\Shell\Open My Folder\Command`

Set the "(Default)" value here to the command that should be executed when the folder is clicked. In this case, it would be "explorer /root,c:\My Personal Data".

Step 4

There's more keys to be created: `HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\CLSID\{FD4DF9E0-E3DE-11CE-BFCF-ABCD1DE12345}\ShellEx\PropertySheetHandlers\{FD4DF9E0-E3DE-11CE-BFCF-ABCD1DE12345}` and `HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\CLSID\{FD4DF9E0-E3DE-11CE-BFCF-ABCD1DE12345}\ShellFolder`. Under this key, create a new binary value called "Attributes" with the value "00 00 00 00".

Step 5

To place the folder in My Computer, add the original key to `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\MyComputer\Namespace\{FD4DF9E0-E3DE-11CE-BFCF-ABCD1DE12345}`. So the key value will be `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\MyComputer\Namespace\{FD4DF9E0-E3DE-11CE-BFCF-ABCD1DE12345}`

Now go to My Computer, and you'll see a new custom folder! ■